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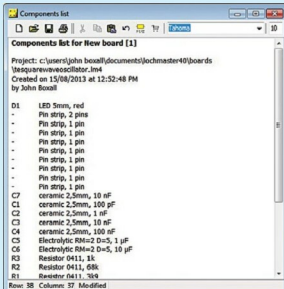


Fig. 2: Window showing components list

the new object assistant.

Test mode to help in tracing signals. LochMaster has a very special feature—the test mode. We can easily figure out the way in which a signal flows and sort out the wanted and unwanted connections with the help of the test mode. If we click at any point in the circuit, the program automatically determines all areas of the board that are connected directly to that point. The program determines all the wires, connections and pins. The areas that are connected will be marked.

Installation

The size of LochMaster is less than 10MB and it can be run even in machines with lesser specifications. The software is distributed electronically after purchase. It is compactable with all versions of Windows, from XP to 8. We can have a backup of the installation file once it is received. It is a quick install and we do not need any extra framework software.

Top competing tools

Mentioned below are some other similar strip board designing tools.

VeroDes. VeroBoard is the same as a strip board. VeroDes is yet another easy-to-use design program for all those who wish to design circuits. We

can easily accommodate board sizes up to 70 holes by 70 tracks in the design. With this software, we can easily visualise both sides of our circuit with links, breaks and component pins marked. It also helps us to modify the design as per our requirements. We can also create our own components having up to 25 pins by 25 pins.

VeeCAD strip board editor. VeeCAD strip board is used for prototypes and small-quantity designs. The tool helps in making the prototyping

practical, replacing the need for a PCB. We can draw our own components and save these in the library for future use. In fact, this tool helps us save hours of planning layouts on graph paper.

Strip board magic. This is a Windows application, developed by a British company called Ambyr, for designing PCB layouts on strip board. Although the interface seems to be quite primitive and a little strange, it is functional even on Windows XP and Linux. One major issue that we face while working with this software is the size of some circuits, which are larger than normal because of the inability of the program to change the orientation of components on the board.

Wouldn't you want to try it out?

If you are a beginner and wish to design something unique for yourself, LochMaster 4.0 could be an ideal choice for you. The tool helps you with an easy-to-design environment with realistic components library and test mode for tracing signals and connections. You can install the software by using the free copy bundled with this month's copy of EFY Plus magazine. ●

The author is a member of the EFY editorial team